

THE BEBOP SHAPE

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #37

If we try to "reverse engineer" the bebop sound, try to figure out some Bebop Best Practices, try to investigate what many of our hero's playing has in common, we'll eventually realize that there is a melodic shape that occurs over and over again. We could call it "Arpeggio Up, and Scale Down."

1

Dmaj7



Charlie Parker solo
on "Confirmation"

2

G7 C Cm7 Gmaj7



Charlie Parker solo
on "Anthropology"

Is this the only Bebop shape? NOPE. Would we ever see a scale up and an arpeggio down? YUP. Would we ever see an arpeggio up AND down. ABSOLUTELY! There are many melodic shapes possible, and jazz musicians certainly use them all. That said, this shape of "Arpeggio Up, and Scale Down" undeniably sounds like Bebop.

Here are two simpler licks to get under your fingers. Begin with just a few keys to begin with, and expand to more (or all 12) from there.

3

Dm7 G7

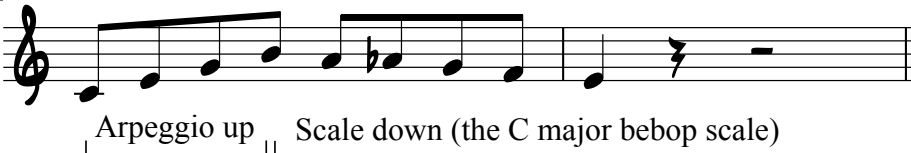


Arpeggio up Scale down (the G dominant bebop scale from B to B)

A good lick with this classic
shape over a ii-V progression.

4

Cmaj7



Arpeggio up Scale down (the C major bebop scale)

A good lick with this classic
shape over a static "I" chord.